ASSIGNMENT 2 · VISUAL DESIGN + UX/UI

A redesingning the Canvas student experience

CURRENT EXPERIENCE → PROPOSED EXPERIENCE

Redesigning a Digital Experience

Student	Alejandro Jair Estrada Pérez
Application	Canvas · Tecnológico de Monterrey
Selected feature	Consulting academic information and performance statistics
Design tool	Canva
Date	November 2026

01 / Selected application and feature

Application: Canvas,the learning management systemusedbyTecnológicodeMonterrey. This analysis focuses on the desktop web experience shown in the student's screenshots.

Selected feature: Consulting academic information and performance statistics. The proposal brings together course grades, assignment progress, upcoming deadlines, and performance trends in one academic dashboard.

User task

A student wants to understand current academic progress, identify which courses need attention, and find the next important assignment without repeatedly opening individual course pages.

Project objective

Redesign the information architecture and visual hierarchy so students can scan key information quickly, compare courses, and move from a summary to detailed course results.

SCOPE	INCLUDED	NOT INCLUDED
Platform	Canvas desktop web interface	Mobile app redesign
Experience	Academic overview, course performance, assignment progress	Full Canvas platform redesign
Output	Visual proposal and user flow	Live integration with Canvas data

Design direction: Keep the familiar Canvas course structure, but add a clear academic overview that summarizes information currently spread across the dashboard, course pages, calendar, and Grades section.

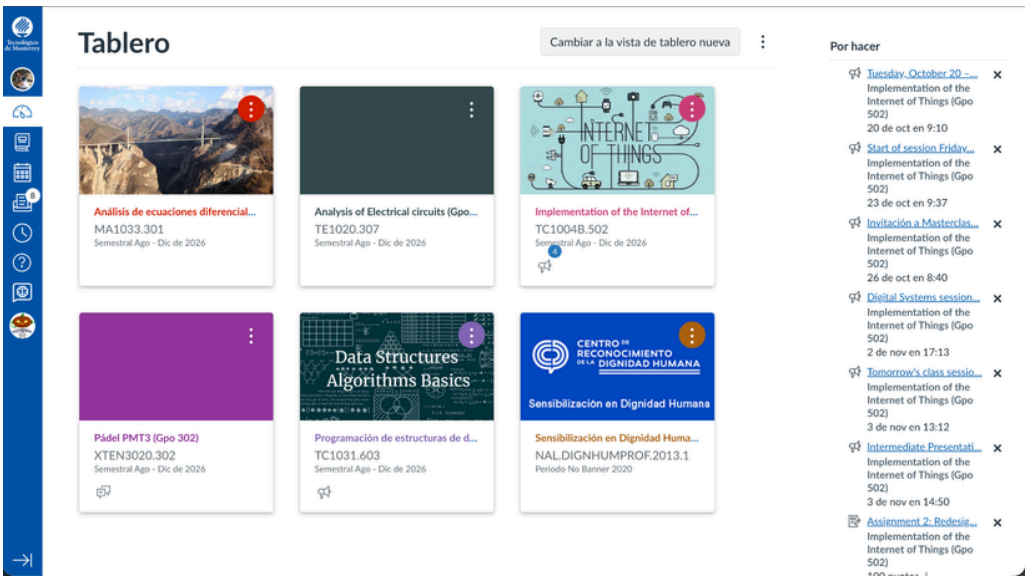
02 / Current experience: entry and course discovery

Thecurrentjourneystartsatthe Canvasdashboard. Students canreviewcoursecards,announcements,andaToDopanel. A separate Courses view provides a text-based list of available courses.

Current user flow

Dashboard → Courses → Select a course → Open course home → Find Grades or course activities → Review individual results.





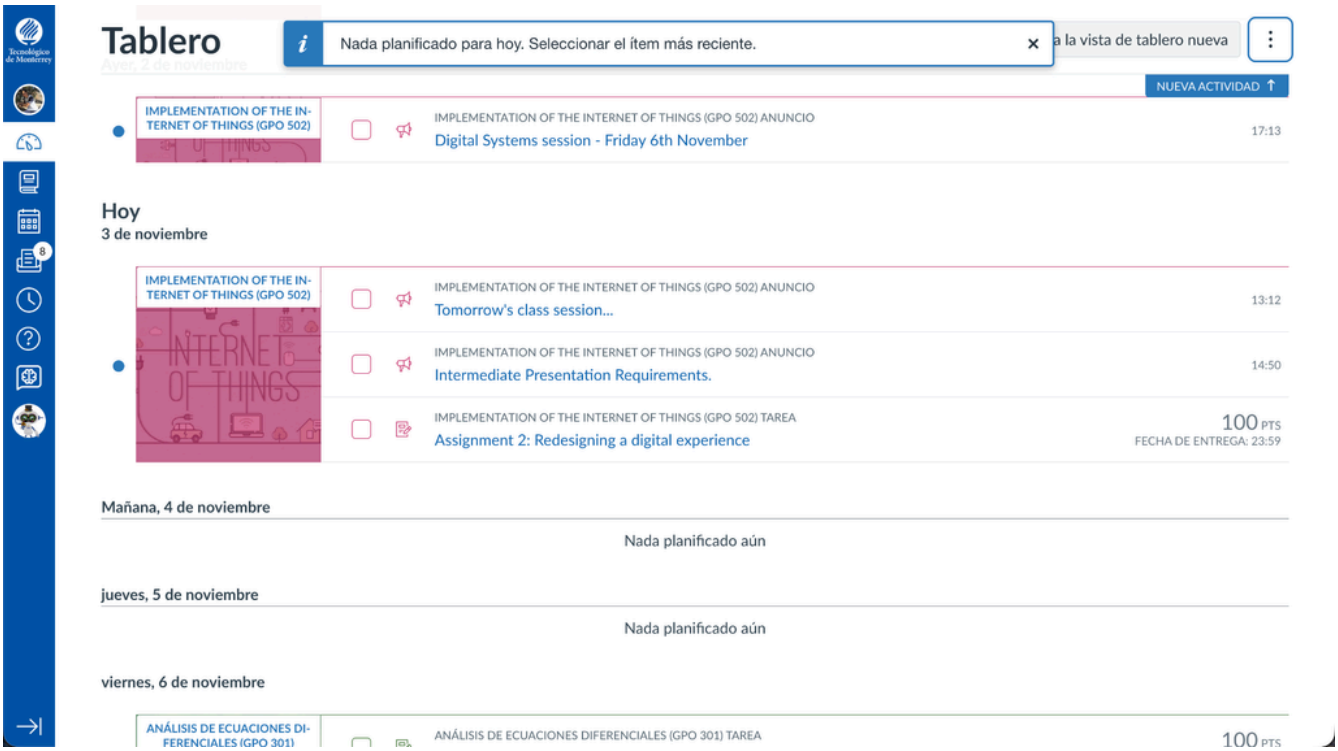
Observation: The dashboard gives quick access to courses and upcoming items, but the visible course cards do not provide a consolidated view of academic performance.

03 / Current experience: course navigation and deadlines

After selecting a course,thestudententers acourse-specifichomepage.Theleftnavigationcontainsmultiple destinations,

while the To Do view presents activities in chronological order.

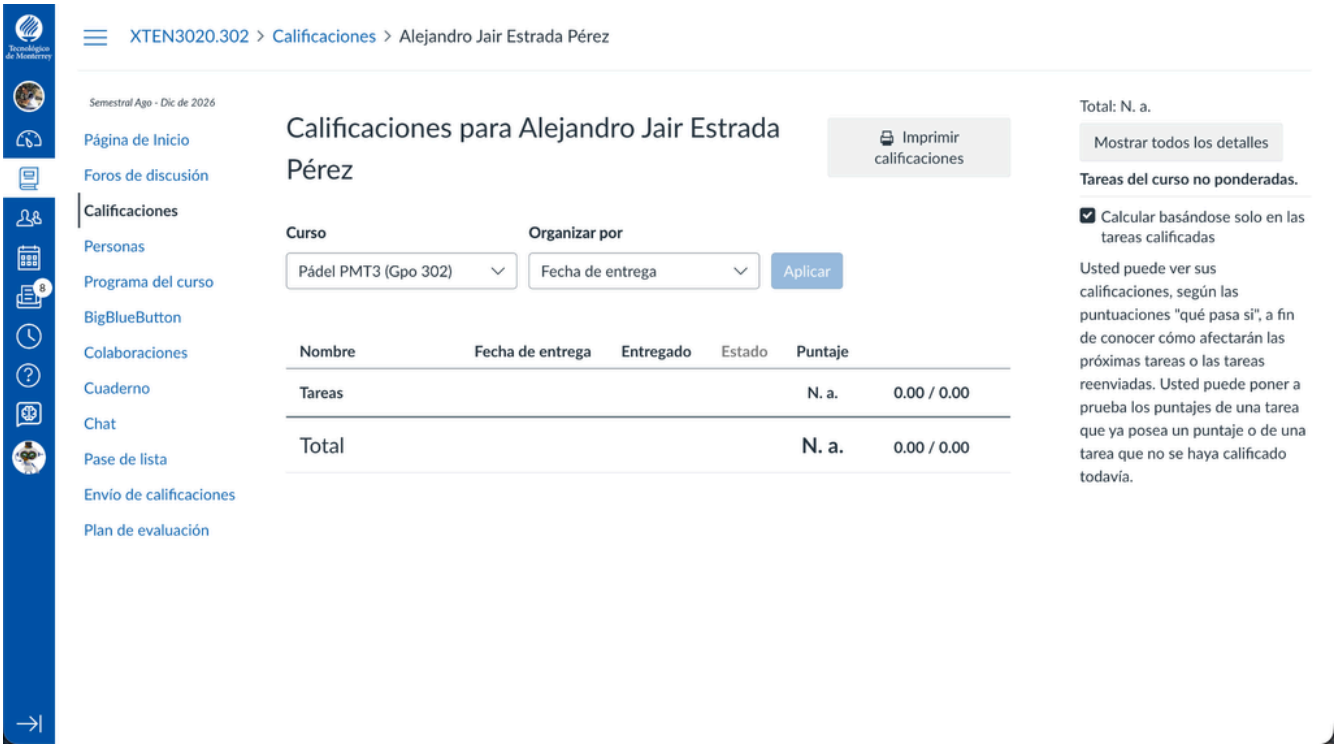




04 / Current experience: individual results and Grades

Theassignmentdetail page providesascore foranindividualactivity.TheGradespageoffersacourseselectorandatablewith assignment name, due date, submission date, status, and score.





05 / UX analysis

Thescreenshots showthat Canvasprovides academic information, but it is distributed across different views. The main opportunity is not to replace the existing tools; it is to make the student's overall academic status easier to understand.

CRITERION	CURRENT OBSERVATION	OPPORTUNITY
Navigation	Students move between dashboard, course pages, activity details, and Grades.	Provide one academic overview with direct links to details.
Hierarchy	Course cards and activity lists are prominent; a cross-course performance summary is not visible in the supplied dashboard.	Prioritize average, progress, pending work, and course status.
Grade visibility	Grades are presented in a table within an individual course.	Show a summary first, then retain the detailed grade table.
Statistics	The supplied screens do not show a consolidated chart across courses.	Add progress indicators and trend visualizations.
Unavailable data	Pádel PMT3 shows N. a. and 0.00 / 0.00; the course notes tasks are not weighted.	Explain unavailable data; do not treat it as a failing grade.
Deadlines	Upcoming work is visible in the To Do panel and chronological list.	Keep deadlines visible with clear priority and due date.

Main UX problem

Students must assemble their academic picture from several separate screens. Canvas provides course-level details, but the supplied experience does not present a single, easy-to-scan overview of performance across courses.

Evidence limitation

The selected Pádel course does not display graded items in the supplied Grades screenshot. The redesign therefore treats unavailable grades as a distinct empty state. Numerical values in the mockups are illustrative sample data, not the student's real grades.

06 / Design proposal: goals and principles

TheredesignintroducesanAcademicPerformanceDashboardwhilekeepingthefamiliarcourse-based structure of Canvas.

01	**Visibility** Show the most important academic indicators immediately.
02	**Progressive disclosure** Present a summary first; open a course for detailed grades and feedback.
03	**Consistent navigation** Keep the same left-side navigation across overview and course analytics.
04	**Clear data states** Distinguish zero, missing, unweighted, and unavailable grades.
05	**Accessible hierarchy** Use readable typography, labels, and color with sufficient contrast.

Visual direction

A Tec-inspired blue and white palette, neutral backgrounds, consistent cards, compact charts, and clear labels. Blue is used for navigation and primary actions; green indicates positive completion; amber signals upcoming work. Color is never the only way to communicate status.

07 / Proposed interface 1: Academic overview

Thefirstscreensummarizesthesemesterinoneplace.Studentscanscanoverallstatus,comparecourseprogress, and identify upcoming deadlines.



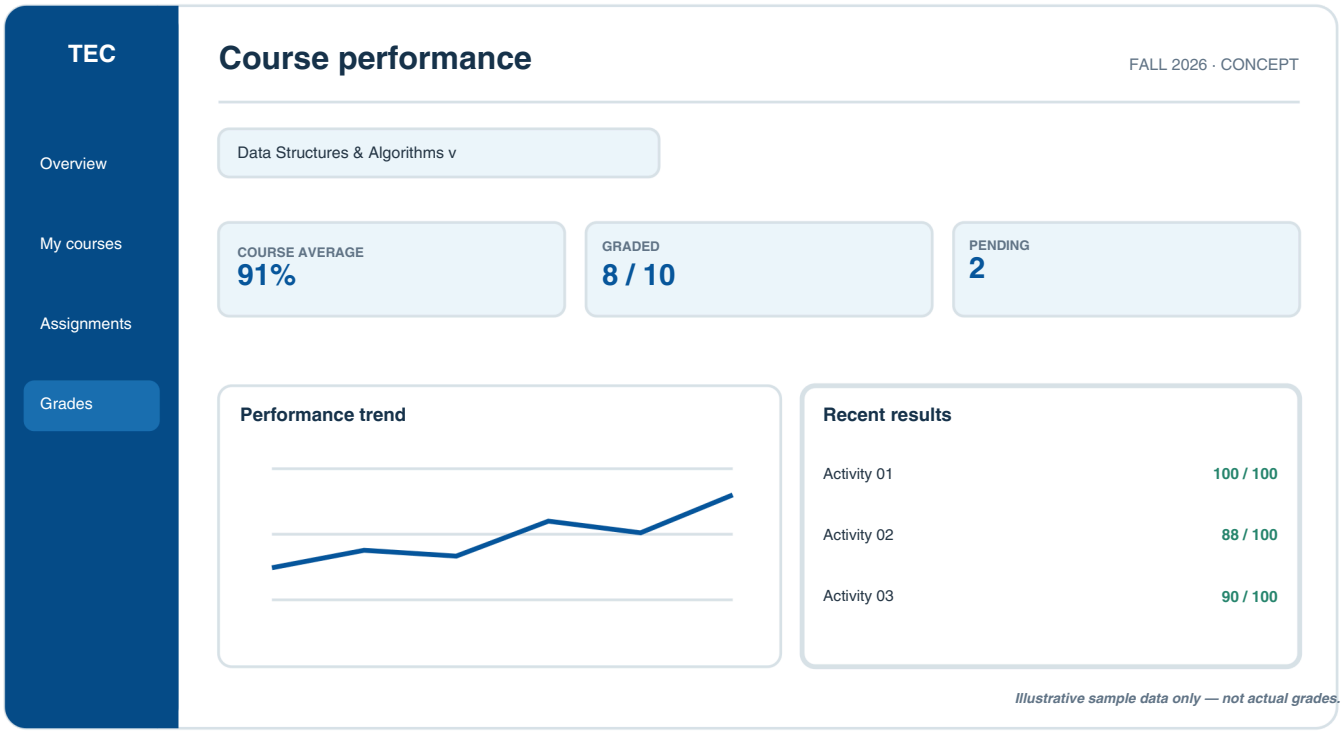
Key elements

Summary cards: overall average, active courses, completed tasks, and deadlines. **Course performance:** a compact comparison across subjects. **Upcoming deadlines:** a short list with dates and direct access to each activity.

Data note: All numerical values shown in this concept screen are illustrative sample data used to demonstrate layout only. They are not actual Canvas records or the student's grades.

08 / Proposed interface 2: Course performance

Selectinga course opensadetailedperformanceview. Thestudentcanreviewcourseaverage,gradedactivities, pending work, performance trend, and recent results without losing the main navigation.



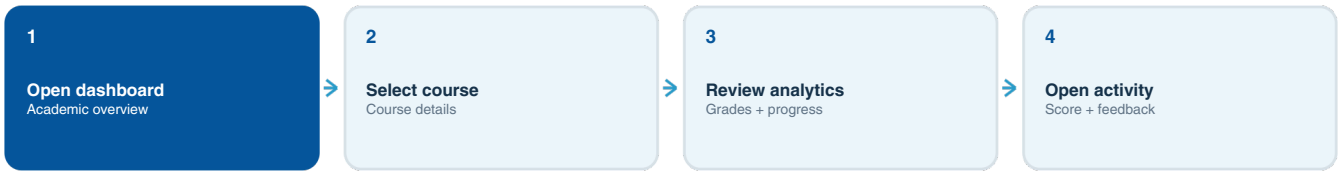
Important empty-state behavior

If a course has no published or weighted grades, the dashboard should not display a misleading 0%. It should show: **“No grade data available yet. This course may not have graded activities or weighted results published.”** The student can still open course activities and review deadlines.

Data note: The 91% average and activity scores in this concept screen are illustrative sample data only.

09 / Proposed user flow

Theredesignedexperience reducesthe need to movebetween separate course pages just to understand overall progress. Detailed information remains available when the student needs it.



Summary first, detailed information only when the student needs it.

Interaction details

STEP	USER ACTION	SYSTEM RESPONSE
1	Open Academic overview	Show summary cards, course comparison, and upcoming deadlines.
2	Select a course card	Open course performance with a consistent course selector.
3	Review trend or activity list	Show progress chart, recent results, and pending activities.
4	Open an activity	Show score, submission status, due date, and instructor feedback.

Feedback and microcopy

Use short, direct messages: “Updated just now”, “2 activities due this week”, “No grade data available yet”, and “View assignment details”. These messages make the system state and next action explicit.

10 / Before and after comparison

CURRENT EXPERIENCE	PROPOSEDEXPERIENCE
Information spread across views Students navigate between dashboard, course pages, To Do, and Grades.	**Centralized overview** A single academic summary links to course-level detail.
Table-first grade presentation The Grades page emphasizes rows and numerical scores.	**Summary + detail** Visual indicators explain performance first; detailed scores remain available.
Limited cross-course comparison The supplied screens do not show one consolidated comparison.	**Course comparison** A compact chart helps students identify courses that may need attention.
Unclear unavailable state N. a. and 0.00 / 0.00 may require interpretation.	**Explicit empty state** Explain when grades are not published or a course is not weighted.

Why the proposal improves UX

The redesign improves findability by placing academic summaries at the entry point; improves efficiency by reducing navigation between separate pages; improves comprehension by combining labels, progress indicators, and charts; and improves trust by distinguishing unavailable grades from low scores. It also preserves access to detailed Canvas course and assignment views.

11 / Design justification and conclusion

Theproposal is based on theobserved structure of the Canvasdesktop experience.The current interface already provides course navigation, activity deadlines, and detailed grade information. The redesign does not remove these capabilities; it creates a clearer entry point for understanding academic progress.

Design decisions

Centralized information: reduces the effort required to assemble a semester overview from multiple screens.

Visual hierarchy: places relevant indicators at the top, followed by course comparisons and deadlines.

Consistent components: repeated cards, labels, and navigation patterns make the interface easier to learn.

Meaningful data states: prevents unavailable grades from being interpreted as failing scores and explains what the student can do next.

Progressive detail: supports movement from a high-level summary to course analytics and an individual assignment.

Conclusion

The Academic Performance Dashboard reinterprets the Canvas experience around the student's main question: “How am I doing, and what should I focus on next?” By centralizing academic indicators and making the path to detailed results clearer, the proposed design aims to make academic information easier to find, compare, and understand.

Limitations and assumptions

This is a visual UX/UI proposal, not a functioning Canvas integration. The screenshots document the student's actual interface. The redesign uses illustrative values solely to demonstrate the visual layout; actual grades, course weights, and assignment data would need to come from Canvas. The supplied Grades screenshot for Pádel PMT3 showed N. a. and 0.00 / 0.00 with unweighted course tasks, so no real average was inferred from it.